

No Strength of Nature Can Suffice

- 1 No strength of nature can suffice
to serve the Lord aright:
and what she has she misapplies
for want of clearer light.
- 2 How long beneath the law I lay
in bondage and distress;
I toiled the precept to obey
but toiled without success.
- 3 Then, to abstain from outward sin
was more than I could do;
now if I feel its pow'r within,
I feel I hate it too.
- 4 Then all my servile works were done
a righteousness to raise;
now, freely chosen in the Son,
I freely choose his ways.
- 5 “What shall I do,” was then the word,
“that I may worthier grow?”
“What shall I render to the Lord?”
is my inquiry now.
- 6 To see the law by Christ fulfilled
and hear his pard'ning voice,
changes a slave into a child,
and duty into choice.

Words: William Cowper, ca. 1772

Music: Irish melody; arr. Charles V. Stanford, 1906

Tune: ST. COLUMBA · CM · Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:14-15

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